

LiftIQ AI — Marketing Strategy

Confidential | July 2026

OVERVIEW

LiftIQ AI's marketing strategy focuses on capturing high-intent gym-goers through organic search, fitness creator partnerships, and community-led growth — before investing in paid acquisition. The goal is to reach 2,000 paying subscribers within 15 months with minimal ad spend.

Core positioning: The AI personal trainer for serious gym-goers who can't afford (or don't want) a real trainer.

Value proposition in one sentence:

> LiftIQ AI builds your training plan, tracks your lifts, coaches your check-ins, and plans your nutrition — for less than one session with a personal trainer per month.

1. TARGET AUDIENCE

Primary Persona — "The Frustrated Self-Programmer"

- Age: 24–38, male or female
- Trains 3–5x per week, has been lifting 1–4 years
- Has tried free programs (Reddit PPL, PHUL, etc.) but doesn't know how to adapt them
- Tracks progress sporadically — maybe a notes app or Hevy
- Would consider a trainer but finds it unaffordable or inconvenient
- Trigger: Hit a plateau, starting a cut, or preparing for an event

Secondary Persona — "The Metrics Nerd"

- Age: 28–45
- Already tracks everything obsessively — calories, sleep, HRV
- Gets DEXA scans 1–2x per year
- Wants to close the loop between body composition data and training
- Trigger: Gets a DEXA scan, wants a platform to track it over time

Channels Where They Spend Time

- Reddit (r/Fitness, r/bodybuilding, r/leangains, r/naturalbodybuilding)
- YouTube (lifting technique, program reviews, physique transformations)
- Instagram (fitness accounts, physique content, supplement brands)
- TikTok (quick workout tips, transformation videos)
- X/Twitter (fitness discourse, training philosophy)

2. MARKETING PILLARS

Pillar 1: SEO & Content Marketing

Goal: Rank for high-intent keywords within 6 months, driving 5,000+ organic visits/month by Q1 2027.

Priority keyword clusters:

Cluster	Example Keywords	Intent
AI training	"AI workout plan generator", "best AI personal trainer app"	High
Program types	"push pull legs program for beginners", "upper lower split 4 days"	High
DEXA	"how to read DEXA scan results", "DEXA scan body fat percentage"	High
Strength tracking	"how to track progressive overload", "1RM calculator"	Medium
Comparison	"Hevy vs LiftIQ", "Fitbod alternative", "Strong app alternative"	High

Content formats:

- Long-form guides (2,000–4,000 words) targeting informational keywords
- Comparison pages targeting "X vs Y" and "X alternative" searches
- Free tools (1RM calculator, macro calculator) as link magnets
- "How to read your DEXA scan" — targets the secondary persona perfectly

Publishing cadence: 2 articles per week for the first 6 months.

Pillar 2: Fitness Creator Partnerships

Goal: 3–5 active creator partnerships by Month 4, each driving 50–200 sign-ups.

Creator profile:

- 10,000–200,000 followers (micro to mid-tier performs better for niche fitness)
- Focus: natty lifting, strength training, powerbuilding, physique
- Audience overlaps with primary persona
- Authentic — they actually train and care about programming

Partnership structure:

- Option A — Affiliate: 20–30% recurring commission on referred Pro subscribers for the lifetime of the subscription. No upfront cost.
- Option B — Paid sponsorship: Flat fee (\$200–800 depending on reach) + 15% affiliate for conversion tracking. For creators with highly engaged audiences.

Outreach approach:

1. DM or email with a personalised note referencing specific content they've made
2. Offer a free Pro account so they actually use the product before promoting it
3. Provide a unique referral link and monthly performance reports
4. Give them a custom landing page with their name/brand ("Built by [Creator] × LiftIQ AI")

Platforms: Instagram and YouTube first. TikTok in Month 4+.

Pillar 3: Community & Reddit

Goal: Establish genuine presence in fitness communities. No spammy posts.

Strategy:

- Founder-led authentic participation in r/Fitness, r/bodybuilding, r/leangains
- Answer questions genuinely — only mention LiftIQ when directly relevant
- Share progress updates, learnings, and behind-the-scenes on r/indiehackers and r/SaaS for secondary audience (builders and early adopters)

- Post genuinely useful content (e.g., "I analysed 1,000 DEXA scans and here's what the data shows") with LiftIQ as the tool

Launch strategy:

- Post a "Show HN" on Hacker News and a launch post on r/Fitness and r/indiehackers
 - Product Hunt launch — target Top 5 of the day for fitness category
-

Pillar 4: DEXA Clinic Partnerships

Goal: 5–10 DEXA clinic referral arrangements by Month 6.

Rationale: People who get DEXA scans are highly motivated and have money to spend on health. LiftIQ's DEXA parsing feature is unique and immediately valuable post-scan.

Approach:

- Contact clinic managers at DEXA/body composition scan centres (DexaFit, BodySpec, independent clinics)
 - Offer them a co-branded landing page: "Got your DEXA scan? Import it into LiftIQ AI in 30 seconds."
 - Revenue share or flat referral fee (\$5–10 per converted Pro subscriber)
 - Patient materials (QR card, email template) they can give to clients post-scan
-

Pillar 5: Referral Program

Goal: Launch by Month 5. Drive 15–20% of new subscribers from referrals.

Mechanics:

- Every Pro subscriber gets a unique referral link
- Referrer earns: 1 free month for every 3 successful referrals
- Referred friend earns: 14-day free trial instead of 7-day (extended trial as incentive)
- In-app referral prompt appears after first completed workout and after every PR

Tracking: Stripe metadata + referral code in the checkout URL.

3. PAID ACQUISITION (MONTH 6+)

Defer paid ads until organic is validated and conversion rates are understood.

When to start: Once MRR > \$3,000 and free-to-paid conversion rate is measured over 30 days.

Channels:

1. Meta (Instagram/Facebook) ads — targeting gym-goers, fitness app users, personal training interest. Lookalike audiences from email list.
2. YouTube pre-roll — target viewers of specific workout channels. 15-second non-skippable format focused on the "AI trainer at 1/10th the cost" hook.
3. Google Search — bid on competitor brand terms (Hevy, Fitbod, Strong app) and high-intent queries ("AI personal trainer app").

Target CAC: Under \$25. At \$12.99/month with ~12-month average LTV, this gives >6x LTV:CAC ratio.

4. RETENTION MARKETING

Acquiring subscribers is half the job. Keeping them is the other half.

In-app triggers (to be built):

- Streak notifications: "You haven't logged a session in 5 days"
- PR celebrations pushed to mobile
- Weekly AI check-in reminder

Email sequences:

1. Onboarding (Days 1–7): Welcome !' First workout guide !' How to use AI check-in !' DEXA feature explanation !' Trial ending reminder
2. Ongoing (monthly): New feature announcements, training tips, PR highlights
3. Win-back (after 30 days inactive): "Your plan is still waiting" + offer an extended trial or discount

Churn indicators to monitor:

- No session logged in 14 days
- No AI check-in in 30 days
- Opened pricing page without converting

5. BRAND GUIDELINES

Voice: Direct, confident, knowledgeable — but not bro-y or cringe. LiftIQ talks like a knowledgeable training partner, not a supplement ad.

Tone words: Precise, honest, performance-driven, intelligent

Avoid: Hype language ("CRUSH your goals!"), generic fitness clichés, stock gym imagery with models who clearly don't lift

Visual identity: Dark background, green accent (#39FF14), monospace font details, data-forward aesthetic. Think Bloomberg Terminal meets elite fitness.

6. KPIS & METRICS

Metric	Month 3 Target	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
Monthly website visitors	2,000	8,000	25,000
Free sign-ups (cumulative)	400	1,500	6,000
Pro subscribers	100	400	1,200
Free-to-paid conversion	10%	15%	20%
Monthly churn	< 8%	< 6%	< 5%
MRR	\$1,299	\$5,196	\$15,588
CAC (organic)	\$8	\$6	\$5
Active creator partnerships	1	4	8

